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DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE INSTRUCTION 34-103

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Services

CONSUMER AFFAIRS PROGRAM

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SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This document has been revised and should be completely reviewed. Changes include incorporating guidance for the inclusion of the USSF.

Section A—Program Purpose

1. Purpose of the Program. This program covers all consumers eligible for goods and services offered by Department of Defense (DoD) and those who are affected by DoD consumer-related activities including Morale, Welfare and Recreation programs, Lodging programs, Army and Air Force Exchange Service and Commissary. The purpose of the program is to:

1.1. Provide a forum for consumer input to improve consumer-related programs. Examples of consumer-related activities are listed in **Attachment 2**.

1.2. Ensure consumers have the opportunity to present their views, and that these views are considered in the Nonappropriated Fund business decision-making process.

1.3. Consolidate feedback of consumers' views captured from consumer surveys.

2. Definition of a Consumer. A consumer is any individual who uses, purchases, acquires, attempts to purchase or acquire, or is offered or furnished any real or personal property, tangible or intangible goods, services, or credit for personal, family or household purposes.

Section B—Roles and Responsibilities

3. Air Force Responsibilities. Consumer Affairs representatives will ensure their organizations:

3.1. Consider consumer concerns in the course of Nonappropriated Fund business decision-making. **(T-1).**

3.2. Coordinate with the cognizant Public Affairs office on matters significantly affecting consumers of DAF products and services, or of interest to a large number of Air and USSF personnel or any information provided to the general public. **(T-1).**

3.3. Coordinate with Office of the Staff Judge Advocate on allegations of consumer fraud or unfair collections practices within DAF retail operations. **(T-1).**

3.4. Ensure their organizations are responsive to the needs and concerns of the consumers. **(T-1).** Subjects will include, but not be limited to, advising management on product selection; adequacy of service; hours of operation; consumer education programs; responsiveness to consumer requirements, suggestions or complaints; and consumer oversight and evaluation.

4. Air Force Services. Air Force Services Center (AFSVC) has primary responsibility for Consumer Affairs, and selects a Consumer Advocate.

4.1. The Air Force Consumer Affairs representative provides Air Force Consumer Affairs Program information to the Office of the Secretary of Defense Consumer Affairs Advisor when requested. Such information addresses:

4.1.1. The organization and staffing structure within the Air Force Consumer Affairs Program, highlighting any changes.

4.1.2. Chief accomplishments in consumer-related programs.

4.1.3. Examples of consumer benefits from regulatory relief activities.

4.1.4. Primary areas of consumer complaints and actions taken to resolve these.

4.1.5. Major meetings, activities or contacts with consumers and consumer-related organizations.

4.2. Other Air Staff offices responsible for consumer activities in their functional areas will provide information for the Consumer Affairs Program to Air Force Services (AF/A1S).

4.3. Other staff agencies within the Air Force may be contacted for Consumer Affairs-related information when gathering information for the Secretary of Defense to include:

4.3.1. Secretary of the Air Force; Office of Public Affairs.

4.3.2. Secretary of the Air Force; Office of Legislative Liaison.

4.3.3. Secretary of the Air Force; Office of the Deputy Chief Management Officer.

4.3.4. Air Force Directorate of Manpower; Organization and Resources.

4.3.5. AFSVC.

4.3.6. Air Force Civil Law Domain's Legal Assistance Policy Division.

4.3.7. Air Force Inspection Agency.

4.3.8. Air Force Safety Center.

4.3.9. Air Force Surgeon General.

4.3.10. Air Force Transportation.

4.3.11. Air Force Chief of Chaplains.

4.3.12. Defense Commissary Agency.

4.3.13. Army and Air Force Exchange Service.

4.3.14. Air Force Civil Engineer Center.

4.3.15. Air National Guard Readiness Center.

4.3.16. Air Force Installation and Mission Support Center.

5. MAJCOMs, Field Commands, Air Force Installation and Mission Support Center (AFIMSC), Air Force Reserve Center, Air National Guard Readiness Center, and United States Air Force Academy will. Ensure consumer-related activities at installations or garrisons have a program for consumers to voice their needs or complaints, obtain referral assistance and receive responsive action. **(T-2).**

5.1. AFIMSC, Air National Guard Readiness Center and United States Air Force Academy will designate a consumer affairs representative to help plan and monitor installation or garrison programs. **(T-1).**

5.2. AFIMSC, Air Force Reserve Center, Air National Guard Readiness Center and United States Air Force Academy will analyze inputs received from installations and garrisons on entitlements. **(T-1).**

6. Installation and Garrison Commander Responsibilities.

6.1. Through their consumer affairs program, installation and garrison commanders will:

6.1.1. Let consumers know how to propose changes. **(T-2).**

6.1.2. Respond to valid consumer requirements and concerns. **(T-2).**

6.1.3. Identify gaps in services provided and recommend new/revised services to meet consumer needs. **(T-2).**

6.1.4. Convey concern about entitlements, benefits, and changes to the proper installation or garrison agency or the next higher headquarters. **(T-2).**

6.1.5. Establish a liaison with the off-base community in concert with the installation or garrison community relations program to keep personnel advised of consumer-related programs and opportunities. **(T-2).**

6.1.6. Educate consumers through commanders' calls, installation or garrison newcomers orientations, installation or garrison newspapers, websites, social media, "hotlines", books, pamphlets, fact sheets, films and American Forces Network Services programs overseas. **(T-2).**

6.2. Inform consumers about issues and pending final decisions that significantly affect them. Installation and garrison commanders or their representatives will use the most appropriate means, which may include internally disseminated information, Armed Forces-affiliated publications, local press, legislature releases, or publication in the Federal Register. **(T-2).**

6.3. Ensure written comments from consumers receive a direct response. This includes comments received via social media, websites, or other digital communication tools utilized by the installation or garrison. Local officials should respond to individual or group consumer suggestions. Moreover, local commanders or their representatives will participate in installation or garrison consumer group activities, such as advisory councils and clubs, to discuss the development and status of consumer suggestions of general interest. **(T-2).**

6.4. Ensure personnel who deal with consumers receive training on proper complaint handling and other consumer affairs responsibilities. **(T-2).** The training should be provided by the functional activity and cover courtesy and attitude in dealing with customers, proper procedures for responding to inquiries and complaints, and disclosure of policies regarding pending DoD or functional matters. **(T-2).**

Section C—Program Execution

7. How the DAF Will Execute the Program.

7.1. Any formal groups or committees created under the Consumer Affairs Program will, if including members that are not uniformed service members, civilian employees, or their family members, comply with Department of Defense Instruction (DoDI) 5105.04, *Department of Defense Federal Advisory Committee Management Program*. **(T-0)**. Per 10 U.S.C. § 1783, any installation advisory groups or councils whose only non-DAF personnel are dependent family members are exempted from Federal Advisory Committee Act (5 U.S.C. App) requirements. Suggested information sources include:

7.1.1. Installation or Garrison Advisory Council.

7.1.2. Consumer Advisory Groups.

7.1.3. Installation Exchange Council (where established).

7.1.4. Consumer Participation Conferences.

7.1.5. Patron Purchase Panels.

7.1.6. Military Community Service Organizations.

7.1.7. Direct contact by consumers with local responsible officials.

7.1.8. Written correspondence.

7.1.9. Suggestion boxes.

7.1.10. Consumer “want” slips.

7.1.11. Inspector General’s interview and complaint systems.

7.1.12. Commissary Advisory Council (where established).

7.1.13. Interactive Customer Evaluation.

7.1.14. Official Air Force Social Media Sites.

JOHN A. FEDRIGO
Principal Deputy Assistant Secretary
(Manpower and Reserve Affairs)

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

DoDI 5030.56, *DoD Consumer Affairs Program,* 17 July 2012

DoDI 5105.04, *Department of Defense Federal Advisory Committee Management Program*, 6 August 2007

DoDD 5400.11, *DoD Privacy Program,* 6 May 2021

DAFPD 34-1, *Air Force Services*, 11 October 2018

DAFI 90-160, *Publications and Forms Managements*, 14 April 2022

DAFMAN 90-161, *Publishing Processes and Procedures*, 15 April 2022

AFI 33-322, Records Management and Information Governance Program, *23 March 2020*

Prescribed Forms

None

Adopted Form

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Publication*

Acronyms and Abbreviations

AF/A1—Deputy Chief of Staff for Manpower, Personnel, and Services

AF/RE—Chief of Air Force Reserve

NGB/CF—Director of the Air National Guard

SF/S1—Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Personnel

Attachment 2

EXAMPLES OF CONSUMER-RELATED ACTIVITIES

A2.1. DoD Products and Services Provided to the Defense Community:

A2.1.1. Dormitories/Barracks

A2.1.2. Military Family Housing

A2.1.3. Adult Continuing Education Programs

A2.1.4. Educational Services

A2.1.5. Passenger and Dependent Travel

A2.1.6. Base Exchanges

A2.1.7. Family Services

A2.1.8. Personnel Customer Assistance

A2.1.9. Bus and Taxi Service

A2.1.10. Family Support

A2.1.11. Refuse and Trash Collection

A2.1.12. AAFES Specialty Stores

A2.1.13. Restaurants and Cafeterias

A2.1.14. Chaplain Services

A2.1.15. Gas Stations

A2.1.16. Force Support Activities and Facilities

A2.1.17. Housing Referral Service

A2.1.18. Shoe Repair

A2.1.19. Combined Federal Campaign

A2.1.20. Snack Bars

A2.1.21. Commissaries, not Private Organization-operated thrift stores

A2.1.22. Laundry and Dry Cleaning Services

A2.1.23. Social Counseling Services

A2.1.24. Clothing Sales Stores

A2.1.25. Linen Exchanges

A2.1.26. Space “A” Travel Program

A2.1.27. Concessionaires

A2.1.28. Supply Consumer Support

A2.1.29. Convenience Stores

A2.1.30. Transportation of Household Goods and Automobiles

A2.2. DoD Products, Services, and Facilities Provided to All or Part of the General Public:

A2.2.1. Activities in Buildings and Facilities to Which the General Public Has Access

A2.2.2. Agricultural Out Leases

A2.2.3. Air Shows and Open Houses

A2.2.4. Cemeteries and Interment Services Programs

A2.2.5. Comprehensive Educational Training Act Programs

A2.2.6. Contracting Services

A2.2.7. Emergency Use of Military Airfields

A2.2.8. Grazing Leases

A2.2.9. Military Assistance to Safety and Traffic Program

A2.2.10. National Historic Properties and Landmark Programs

A2.2.11. Natural Resources Educational Programs

A2.2.12. Non-military Use of Ranges, Firing and Other Public Transit through Military Danger Zones

A2.2.13. Public Access to Military Installations or Garrisons, Properties, and Facilities

A2.2.14. Sale of Utility Services

A2.2.15. Timber and Timber Product Sales

A2.2.16. Use of Material Recycling Centers

A2.2.17. Use of Military Medical Facilities for Emergency Care